

introducing improved cattle breeds and modern milk collection and storage facilities, the Foundation is creating a self-sustainable dairy ecosystem that provides long-term livelihood support to farming families.

One exemplary initiative is the Anuradha Dairy and Milk Collection Centre from Gondia district in Maharashtra that is fetching higher prices for farmers through effective supply chain management and marketing strategies. Recognising the potential of dairy development in the region, the Adani Foundation introduced an integrated approach encompassing breed improvement, fodder management, cattle healthcare services, and marketing of milk in 26 villages.

In 2019, the Foundation supported the formation of a farmer producer company named Tiroda Farmer Producer Company Ltd (TFPCL). Through TFPCL, the Foundation facilitated the establishment of the Anuradha Dairy initiative with the support of AMUL. Currently, this initiative benefits more than 2,000 farmers in the Tirora block. The Farmer Producer Organisation (FPO) operates 45 milk collection centres with the support of SHGs of Mahila Arthik Vikas Mahamandal (MAVIM). The collected milk is supplied to the Panchmahal District Co-operative Milk Producer's Union Ltd., Godhra (Gujarat) under the brand Anuradha Dairy.

Presently, Anuradha Dairy collects 17,000 litres of milk per day. In the financial year 2023-24, the dairy collected an average of 3.1 lakh litres of milk per month, with an average monthly payment of Rs 1.5 crore directly deposited into farmers' bank accounts. Since the inception of the project, dairy farmers of Tirora have cumulatively earned Rs 36.94 crore, receiving 30%-40% higher prices for the milk collected.

Beyond benefiting farmers, Anuradha Dairy has generated employment for 134 women, offering them a monthly income ranging from Rs 4,000 to Rs 5,000. These women, organised in the form of self-help groups (SHGs), run the milk collection centres, exemplifying the role of women in driving economic growth and community development.

Inspired by the success of this dairy model, the initiative is expanding with the support of the state government. This expansion includes the addition of a 30 KLPD (thousand litres per day) milk chilling centre, which is set to commence operations soon, covering two blocks of Gondia district. This new facility will further enhance the capacity and efficiency of milk processing, ensuring that farmers can consistently meet market demands and secure better prices for their produce.

Another commendable initiative started in Kawai few years back is now fetching farmers handsome amount. After a survey on the scope of animal husbandry in the region, the Foundation held meetings with the farmers in Kawai to create awareness about the breed improvement through artificial insemination and dairy development. Two breed improvement centres were opened in Neemoda and Bamori villages in 2017.

Through artificial insemination, over 2,000 improved breeds with higher milk production were born, starting in 2017-18. To promote women's empowerment and increase their involvement in the project Hadothi Pragatisheel Producer Company (HPCC) was formed with 10 shareholders in March 2022. In response to HPCC shareholders' requests, Neemoda Milk Samiti was established in the same year with five village-level

centres, starting with only 8 litres of milk collected on June 22, 2022.

Adani Foundation connected with farmers, efficiently channelising surplus milk. Within a month, milk collection increased by 700 litres, and FPO membership grew to over 500. Adani Foundation then met with Amul Dairy, resulting in an agreement with Sabar Dairy to collect 10,000 litres of milk within a 50 km radius.

In March 2024, with the Foundation's support, Sabar Amul began collecting 800 litres per day. Regular meetings with farmers and village-level in-charges increased milk collection to 6,000 litres per day, valued at Rs 84 lakh per month.

The Adani Foundation's commitment to sustainable livelihood programmes like dairy development is not only boosting farmers' incomes but also fostering community resilience and economic stability. By integrating modern agricultural practices with traditional knowledge, the Foundation is paving the way for a brighter, more prosperous future for rural communities.

The dairy development initiatives spearheaded by the Adani Foundation are a shining example of how targeted support and innovative approaches can transform livelihoods. The success stories of individuals like Priyanka Mehta and the thriving operations of Anuradha Dairy highlight the profound impact of these programmes. As the Foundation continues to expand its reach and refine its strategies, the positive ripple effects on farmers' lives and the broader community are sure to continue growing, creating a legacy of empowerment and sustainable development.

